Jordan Garrison

Cloud Platform Engineer

Engineer | Lifelong learner. Relentlessly curious.

I build the platforms that turn infrastructure from a bottleneck into a superpower.

jordan@jordangarrison.dev | jordangarrison.dev | linkedin.com/in/jordan-garrison | Austin, TX

SKILLS

Specialized Skills

Developer Platforms | GitOps | Immutable Systems | SLOs | Load Testing | Distributed Systems | Incident Response

Languages

Go | TypeScript | NodeJS | Python | Bash

Platforms

Kubernetes | Istio | Argo | SST | Fastly | Spark | Kafka | Hadoop

Infrastructure as Code

Terraform | CDK | Helm | Kustomize | Ansible | Chef | Puppet

Observability

Prometheus | Grafana | Kibana | Datadog | APM

Linux

NixOS | Ubuntu | Oracle Enterprise Linux | Amazon Linux | Fedora | CentOS | Debian

CI/CD

GitHub Actions | Jenkins | Google CloudBuild

Databases

MySQL | Postgres | DynamoDB | BigQuery | HBase | Hive | InfluxDB

Caches

Redis | Memcached | Varnish (Fastly)

Indexes

Elasticsearch | Solr | Manticore | OpenSearch

Management

Hiring | Contracting | Roadmapping | 1:1s | Performance Reviews | OKRs

Project Management

Agile | Scrum | Kanban | Jira | Confluence | PI Planning | Standups | Retrospectives | Scrum Master

EDUCATION

Texas A&M University
Bachelor of Science, Physics | Minor: Mathematics
2012 – 2017

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

Promotion to Tech Lead — FloSports, 2023
Top Performer - Own It — FloSports, 2021
Promotion to Senior Infrastructure Engineer — FloSports, 2021
CEO Life Saving Award — General Motors, 2019
CIO Safety Award — General Motors, 2019
Early Promotion out of New College Hire Program — General Motors, 2019
CIO Distinguished New College Hire — General Motors, 2018, 2019

CERTIFICATIONS

Advanced GitOps Certification — Apr 2024
Credential ID: 101100053
GitOps certification for using the Akuity platform to manage Kubernetes

EXPERIENCE

Tech Lead Manager, SRE | FloSports

Nov 2019 – Present

From Infrastructure Engineer to Tech Lead Manager. Building developer platforms, driving cloud migrations, and establishing SRE practices for a live sports streaming platform.

Promotions: *Infrastructure Engineer (2019), Senior Infrastructure Engineer (2021), Tech Lead Manager, SRE (2023)*

- **GCP to AWS Cloud Migration:** Architected and executed full cloud consolidation from GCP to AWS. Migrated 20+ services including databases, caches, and CI/CD pipelines to EKS with zero downtime. Created self-service migration templates for teams.
- **Load Testing Platform:** Built distributed K6 load testing platform from scratch across 4+ phases. Built traffic replay system using GoReplay, Istio, PubSub, and BigQuery for production traffic capture and replay. Evolved to Kubernetes-native with K6 Operator, dedicated UI, CI/CD integration, and browser-level tests. Validates readiness for major live sporting events.
- **Developer Experience Platform:** Built flo-deploy, opinionated Helm charts, and infrastructure-manifests to give developers a paved road to production. Authored RFC for Crossplane-based self-service platform.
- **Observability & SRE Transformation:** Migrated to Datadog unified observability from fragmented stack (NewRelic, SignalFX, ELK) and restructured team from DevOps/Infra to SRE to align outcomes with business goals. Established SLO-based culture with per-service reliability reporting, scorecards, and incident response frameworks.

Infrastructure as Code

- **Terraform Foundation**: Built unified IaC across GCP and AWS. 185+ PRs to infra-base-services. Created reusable Terraform modules for RDS Aurora, ElastiCache, EKS clusters.
- **Helm Charts Evolution**: Evolved from Kustomize overlays to Terraform modules to opinionated Helm charts for standardized EKS deployments. Authored 11 RFCs including "Why not use Terraform for Everything."
- **EKS Platform**: Multiple EKS upgrades (1.25 through 1.30), Karpenter adoption, Istio service mesh management. Exploring EKS Auto-Mode for reduced operational overhead.

CI/CD & Developer Experience

- **flo-deploy**: Created deployment proxy GitHub Action from scratch (64+ PRs). Pull-based pipelines, simplified rollbacks, self-service deployments for all engineering teams.
- **CI/CD Migration**: Migrated from GCP Cloud Build to GitHub Actions. Built shared workflows, runner health monitoring, and preview environments.
- **Service Playbooks & Standards**: Authored comprehensive onboarding docs, conducted weekly SRE roadshows auditing each platform's observability. Built gold standard examples for SST and Kubernetes deployments.

Cost Optimization & Security

- **FinOps & Cost Management**: $200K+/yr S3 VOD savings. Datadog cost optimization targeting 40–60% savings. Established resource tagging standards and FinOps framework.
- **Security Incident Response**: Led GitHub token exposure remediation (367 repos affected), botnet attack response, SQLi attack investigation, WAF hardening.

Reliability & Event Stability

- **Major Event Preparation**: ADCC 2024, Wrestling Big Weekend, FloCollege Launch, Next Gen Wrestling (99.95% uptime target with 500k redirected users doubling traffic volume).
- **Resilience Engineering**: Implemented chaos testing framework with deploy gates, SLOs for key user journeys, graceful degradation patterns. Authored 40+ incident investigations with systematic root-cause analysis.

Big Data Platform Engineer | General Motors

May 2017 – Nov 2019

Big Data Platform Engineer managing Hadoop clusters with thousands of users. Built monitoring systems, security frameworks, and automation tools.

Promotions: *L5 Big Data Platform Engineer (2017), L6 Big Data Platform Engineer (2019)*

- **Data Governance & Security:** Implemented full data governance and lineage toolchain with Apache Ranger and Atlas across Hadoop clusters. Established RBAC framework with self-service user management used org-wide.
- **Yarn Queue Manager:** Built Go-based utility for automated Yarn queue scheduling. Optimized cluster resource allocation between data science workloads during business hours and batch reporting off-hours.
- **Hadoop Monitoring Stack:** Built comprehensive monitoring ecosystem with PHP/JavaScript frontend, Oracle backend, and Python metrics collection system using Prometheus and Grafana for previously invisible cluster metrics. Became the standard platform for cluster observability and performance analysis.

Research Technician | Lynntech

Apr 2016 – May 2017

Research Technician building IoT prototypes with Python, Arduino, and Raspberry Pi. Hardware meets software.

- **Iodine Detection Kit:** Developed NIH-funded prototype for affordable water iodine detection in regions with high hypothyroidism rates. Built IoT solution using Raspberry Pi, Arduino, and colorimeter with Python-based Qt interface.
- **Desalination Monitor:** Created Arduino-based monitoring system for seawater desalination validation. Implemented pH and salinity sensors with visual feedback interface for rapid water quality assessment.
- **Muscle-Powered Pacemaker:** Prototyped circuit designs for a muscle-powered pacemaker concept, combining hardware prototyping with Python programming for data collection and analysis.

Instrument Repair Technician | Music and Arts

Jan 2013 – Jan 2016

Assistant repairman for musical instruments. Cleaning, minor dent repair, pickup and delivery with band directors, and billing when needed.

Marine Mechanic Assistant | Plano Marine — Jan 2012 – Dec 2012

Assistant to marine mechanics. Moving boats in and out of bays and making mechanics' lives easier.

Sales Associate | Nelson's Fireworks — Jun 2010 – Jul 2010

Seasonal sales during the 4th of July rush. Explaining products and helping customers find what they need.

Data Analyst | Texas A&M Department of Physics & Astronomy — Jan 2014 – Dec 2014

Introduction to distributed computing. Simulated Higgs Boson particle collisions using C++ and Bash.